

STOP PUSHING BUTTONS!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #123

Pushing buttons, pulling strings, pressing keys, hitting drums . . . however you interact with your instrument, it's too easy to just "push buttons" and hope for the best. Let's develop the ability to have a sense of what is going to come out the other end of the instrument. What rhythm are we REALLY playing? What will this lick ACTUALLY sound like? Is the voicing I am playing anything like what I'm hearing in my head?

How to achieve this? By internalizing little (like, *really little*) bits of information. Know those little bits like the back of your hand. We want that little bit of information to NEVER surprise you again. And, if you do this with just 8 or 10 little bits of information, little sounds, little devices, little rhythms, you'll be SHOCKED at how much you can hear. Your Button Pushing days will be over!

As mentioned above, we could talk about a piano voicing, a comping rhythm or a drum sticking. For our example here, let's look at internalizing an interval - the minor third.

#1 - Minor Third



#2 - Minor Third "jazz melody"



#3 - Fascinatin' Rhythm (Gershwin)



#4 - A Love Supreme (Coltrane)



A lot of melodies and licks use minor 3rd intervals, and many of those also include the 4th scale degree (minor pentatonic, anyone?!). The classic melodies in #3 and #4 here use the exact same building blocks as each other, all based around the interval of a minor 3rd. Learn to hear it!